Findings Barcelona WFC

Clustering results

At k = 2, Barcelona were clustered with front footed teams, but only just. Then at k = 3 and k = 4, Barcelona were clustered with passing teams at a slightly bigger margin, but still sat between groups.

Like front-footed teams

Barcelona were particularly aggressive in average defensive location; in fact, their average defensive location was in the opposition half. They were also active with counterpress actions in opposition half. For a team of their strength, their box entries were done more via passes.

Like patient teams

Barcelona were not progressive when it comes to passing. More of their shots were from open play and less were from direct set piece and counter attacks.

Like passing teams

When their strength was taken into account, Barcelona were average in terms of directness and long goal kicks, shot more from open play and fewer from direct set piece and transitions, and passed into the final third through the middle more than patient teams did.

Pitch profile

Only a fifth of Barcelona's attack went down the middle, while the left flank was significantly more used than the right flank.

Formations and typical XI

4-3-3 was the most used formation by Barcelona by a significant margin. Most positions saw significant rotations throughout the season, apart from Bonmati as right center midfield, Graham Hansen as right winger, Batlle at left back.

Similar teams

Being the most dominant team, Barcelona ended up with a squad similarly built to Bristol City, the least dominant team. However, there were more teams that played like Barcelona than built like Barcelona.

The full Barcelona team report (PDF).